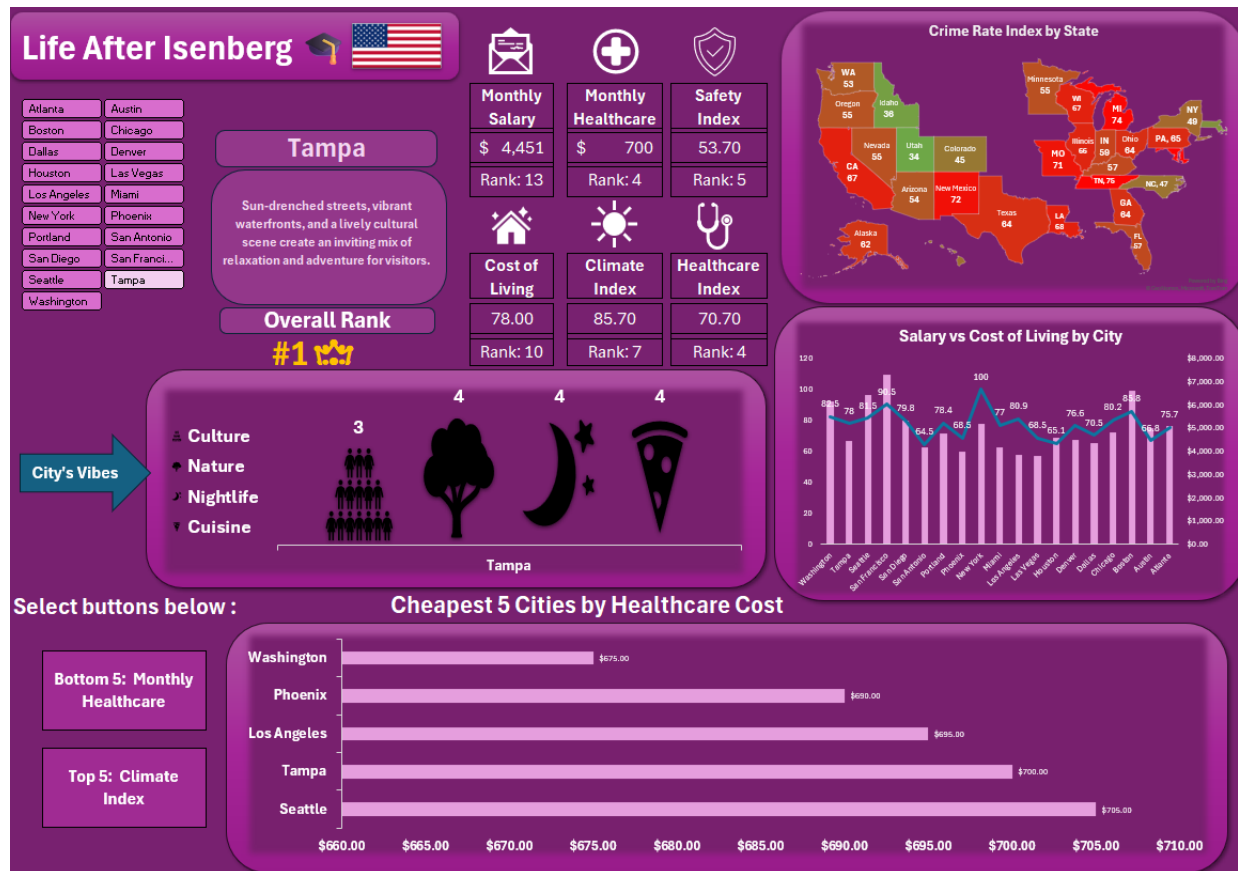


City Comparison Dashboard

Excel & VBA — Interactive Relocation & Job-Offer Decision Tool

A dashboard comparing 15 U.S. cities across salary, cost of living, healthcare, climate and lifestyle data, built to make relocation and job-offer decisions easier to reason about side by side. Every city is ranked, scored and visualized so the strongest overall option is clear at a glance.



Main dashboard view — city rankings, map chart and slicers

Ranking Methodology

Five separate datasets, pulled from Google and other public sources, were combined to score all 15 cities on different dimensions (salary, cost of living, healthcare quality, climate, and lifestyle factors). Excel's RANK function was applied to each dataset individually, then the rankings were averaged across all five to produce a single overall composite rank per city — surfacing the best all-around city rather than the best on any one metric alone.

- 15 cities scored across 5 independent datasets
- RANK function applied per-metric, then averaged into one composite score
- Conditional formatting highlights rank #1 with a glowing crown icon, #2 in silver, #3 in bronze

Visualizations & Pivot Tables

Multiple pivot tables feed the dashboard's charts: a map chart plots crime rate index by state, a "City's Vibes" panel scores culture, nature, nightlife and cuisine using icon-style bars instead of standard bar charts, and a combo chart tracks salary against cost of living across all 15 cities at once.

Interactive Macros

Two VBA-driven buttons make the dashboard interactive rather than static: "Bottom 5: Monthly Healthcare" instantly displays the 5 cheapest cities by healthcare cost, and "Top 5: Climate Index" displays the 5 best cities by climate score. Each click triggers a macro that filters the underlying data and redraws the associated chart automatically — no manual filtering required.

Download the Full File

Want to explore the slicers, macros and pivot tables yourself? Download the original working Excel file below.

[Download City Comparison Dashboard \(.xlsm\)](#) →

Tools & Skills

Excel, VBA (Macros), Pivot Tables, RANK Function, Conditional Formatting, Data Modeling

Prepared by Ashar Shamim | asharshamim@umass.edu | asharshamim.com